

ROPE BED -

design only-

NOT TO SCALE

all measurements in mm

25mm deep blind mortise to hold bedhead. Not required on tail legs.

Short side - one end only shown. overall length 1120mm

Hole cut to match tapered wedge. wedges inserted from centre of long side towards head/tail of bed

Cutting List

Legs: 4 off 75x40x120 glue to make 2 off 75x75x120 (head)
 4 off 75x40x620 " " " 2 off 75x75x620 (tail)
 Long sides: 2 off 100x40x1930
 Short sides: 2 off 100x40x1120
 Headboard: 1 off 100x25x760
 Wedges: 4 off 100x20x20 tapered

CONSTRUCTION NOTES

All the pieces I have built so far to this design have been in American white Ash - no problems to date.

The sizes of the BARS are nominal, and can safely be amended to your own design. I buy my timber rough sawn, so it finishes out at 40mm after planing/thicknessing. The size is just about perfect for this project.

One caveat I would add is that the sides, at 100mm are more or less as shallow as they can go, I'm happy that an average sized male of around 5' 10" and 15 stone would have no issues with the timber bowing, still less failing; but, for the LARGER Norman(!) if you would feel safer using deeper boards, up to 125mm it will cause no problems. Leave the joints the size they are and simply centre them on the wider boards

THE HEADBOARD is the only non standard thickness in the cutting list, and I've made mine so far out of a plank of oak I had, largely to give some facility for carving, either fretty or other decoration such as bas relief. Lime would be suitable and possibly look better colour wise. Your shout.

Making the LEGS up involves jointing and gluing. Because of the exterior use, I like to use a waterproof glue - cascamite does a good job. Once again, your shout. Glue them up and then thickness to size. Height from the floor is your choice - I use 300mm to the bottom of the main joint with the long rail.

When you cut your MORTISES for the legs, cut through the glue joint (so the joint is parallel to the long side of the bed) rather than the other way. Its stronger and it looks better.

WEDGES are used to hold the bed together - they are installed in this design in the opposite direction to normal, which CAN lead to 'racking', but doesn't seem to on this design.

FINISHING would normally be linseed - but I BLOODY HATE the smell! I've had excellent results using an exterior emulsion (sort of a decking wax, but it includes some polyurethane for wear resistance) that I picked up from Aldi. It gives excellent results, indistinguishable from Linseed (apart from the smell)

I can't copyright this design, as I do it for fun, and I'm happy for other people to use, or modify my design for personal use.

If you're a commercial builder, and make use of the design, I would ask you not to, but if you do, at least give me some credit in your work.

Then I can hunt you down like a dog.

Percival de Scrotum (wrinkled retainer to the De la Haye family)